

Knowing the Score

I once kept score on an agency man I entertained from 6 p.m. until 1 in the morning. During that period he consumed 16 scotch and sodas.

~ Joseph Barbera

No, the process of getting your credit report and correcting any errors should not be driving you to drink. And no, there is no reason to invite your banker out to wine and dine him. He should be doing that for you.

In this whole process of curing your debt, it is important to remember to focus on the days ahead and smile. And now if you ever go on *Jeopardy!*, and the Daily Double lists TransUnion, Equifax, and Experian, you will answer without hesitating, “What are the three national credit reporting agencies, Alex?!”

Never forget that we will have the last laugh in dealing with the greedy lending institutions and banks and credit card companies. They think that they have us in their pockets for life because we carry their cards in our wallets. It does not have to be so. I know their secrets, and it is time that the entire American public knows them as well.

If a person knows there is a scam, they won't be taken. It's as simple as that.